

10 mindset shifts

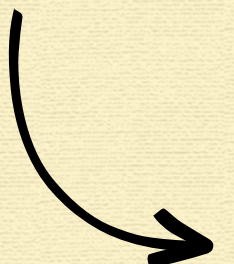
REQUIRED

to **stop** being a

**tactical research
function**

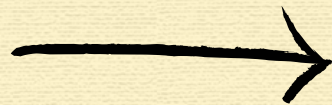
and **start** being a

**strategic insights
engine**



1.

Homeostasis



Allostasis

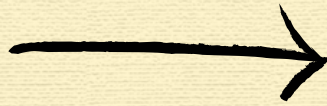
Surviving, optimizing for a
baseline or benchmark, &
maintaining the status quo

Evolving, optimizing
for upside & potential,
& adapting to changing
dynamics

2.

Collecting the dots

Harvesting inputs but
mostly hoarding them,
often leaving distinct
inputs separate & siloed



Connecting the dots

Extracting value from
them, specifically by
drawing connections

3.

**Answering
(any)
question**

Obsessing over the best, quickest, cheapest, most efficient way to get an answer



**Asking
(better)
questions**

Obsessing over the right question to ask before blindly chasing answers

4.

Paying bills

- short term
- point in time
- immediate next steps
- isolated activities
- linear progress



Generating dividends

- long term
- bigger picture
- future directions
- integrated narratives
- exponential impact

5.

Research



research

Handicapping your efforts
(or your budgets) by
thinking information,
answers, and insights come
only from big, slow, formal
research efforts

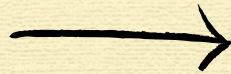
Capitalizing on the wealth
of methods, tools &
channels you can use to
creatively monitor or
pulse check actions,
sentiments, & perceptions

6.

Focusing on the pixel

Operating myopically,
often without knowledge
of or concern for context*

** necessary at times; limiting at scale*



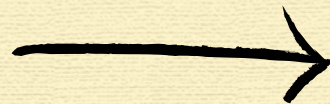
Focusing on the big picture

Widening your aperture to
consider & connect multiple
dynamics, angles, & time
horizons

1.

**Being
retroactive**

Reacting to requests &
being an order taker



**Being
proactive**

Wondering, exploring, &
uncovering opportunities

8.

**Being a
comfort blanket**



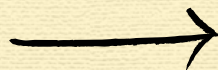
**Being a
search light**

Aiming to confirm, validate,
reassure, find a data point or
answer, prove subjectively

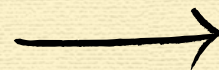
Aiming to disprove, uncover,
explore, let the answer
reveal itself, stay objective

9.

What
(data)



So what
(insights)



Now what
(strategic
insights)

Collecting
inputs

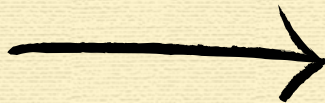
Surfacing why
they matter

Having a POV on what
to do with or how to
extract value from them

10.

Running a marathon

Getting overwhelmed
by all the steps, inputs,
considerations & the
“ideal state”



Taking the first step

Getting started with a
manageable piece &
building bit by bit
from there

*Eat the elephant — but please
don't harm any animals!*